poor and marginalized Muslims being razed by the authorities in Delhi's Jahangirpuri, which had witnessed communal violence on April 16 during a Hanuman Jayanti procession. The only mainstream politician to oppose this was the CPI(M) leader Brinda Karat, who dramatically stood in front of a bulldozer as she denounced the government's 'communal political game plan' and moved the Indian Supreme Court to order a stay on grounds that she described as `selective and discriminatory action'.[16] In this way, unlike others, she as a politician has proved herself a worthy successor to the legacy of Bhagat Singh.

For the most part, however, hope for the future must come in the shape of the youth in both countries. It was so in the febrile atmosphere of the 1920s, and it is so now. The future lies with them. Their student movements protesting against the government have shaken both New Delhi and Lahore. Following a four-week-long agitation by students of New Delhi's Jawaharlal Nehru University against an increase in hostel fees which would put a squeeze on the ability of poorer students to join India's elite research university, hundreds of people decided to take part in a 'Citizen's March' in support of them at the end of 2019. Students from neighbouring states concerned about rising education costs also joined in, as did members of political parties. Standing beside Parliament Street Police Station, where Bhagat Singh and Batukeshwar Dutt were kept under arrest after they had exploded bombs at the central Legislative Assembly in 1929, Sitaram Yechury, a former president of the JNU Students' Union, quoted Bhagat Singh's reply when questioned about the actions of the students: 'If the deaf are to hear,' he repeated the memorable words of Bhagat Singh, 'the sound has to be very loud.'[17]

In Pakistan too there have been long-standing student concerns. These have included a ban on their unions, absence of protocols to deal with sexual harassment, rise in annual fees, as well as a general lack of satisfaction with the quality of education offered. All these led to the formation in 2016 of the Progressive Students' Collective in Lahore. When in June 2019, a 37% budget cut to the country's higher education development programme was announced by the government, the Students'